

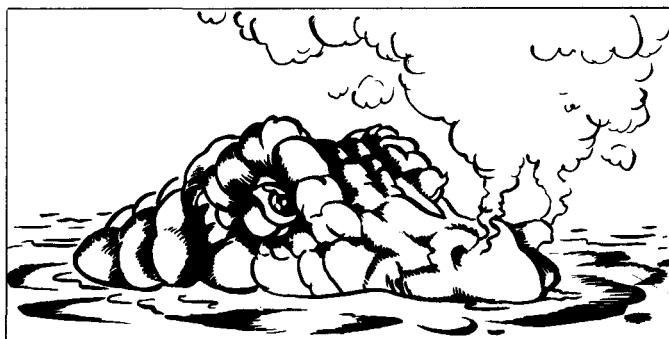
INTRODUCTION

When the characters reach 9th level (**name level**), they will be strong enough to settle new lands and build castles of their own. This opens many new opportunities for role-playing as the players try to run small holdings or baronies.

Most important, the characters in the wilderness campaign do not exist in a vacuum. The DM should have events going on elsewhere that may affect (or be affected by) the actions of the players. There may be any number of "plots" going on at once, and the DM should try to involve each player in some chain of events. These should develop logically from the actions of those involved. **It is important not to force the action to a pre-determined conclusion.** The plot lines can **always** be adjusted for the actions of the players.

High and Low Level Characters

During a campaign new player characters will be entering the game, either to replace those that have died or to bring new players into the campaign. At the same time, experienced and successful players will have characters who continue to advance in levels. This results in a situation where there is a large difference in the levels of players. This can create problems since higher level characters must overcome greater risks and more fearsome monsters to keep the game challenging and to gain enough experience to increase in level. Lower level characters will usually die in the same situations. Reversing the situation (high level characters travelling on low level adventures) creates boredom and quickly unbalances the game. As a guideline, *not a rule*, it is suggested that characters who have a difference in levels of 5 or greater play in separate adventures. Thus, a 3rd level thief and an 8th level magic-user should play at different times. This guideline will not apply at all times, and should not be used when dealing with retainers.



Using D&D Expert rules with an early edition of D&D Basic

If your copy of the D&D Basic rules has a blue cover with a picture of a dragon on it, then this section is for you. If not, you may skip this section and turn to Part Two, **CHARACTERS**.

This section was written to allow those who have the older, blue D&D Basic rules to use them with D&D Expert. Only the important differences between the two sets of rules are given here. However, in any place where the older D&D Basic rules and the new D&D Expert rules differ, the D&D Expert rules should be used.

In reading this book, DMs and players should remember that situations will arise that are not covered in the rules. In these situations, the DM should use personal judgment to resolve any problems. The freedom allowed to players and DMs is one of the strengths of the D&D rules system, and that has been continued here.

The following is a summary of new material in the 2nd edition of D&D Basic not found in this book, the D&D Expert rules. Also several charts from D&D Basic have been reprinted on the back of the title page for reference.

D&D: EXPERT

In the second edition of D&D Basic rules, ability bonuses and penalties was expanded to include all abilities (see page X2).

Character Alignment

The alignment system used in D&D Expert is somewhat different from that used in the 2nd Edition of the D&D Basic rules. There are three possible alignments for a character, as below:

Law (or **Lawful**) represents respect for rules, and willingness to put the benefit of the group ahead of the benefit of individuals. Lawfuls respect fairness and justice.

Chaos (or **Chaotic**) is the opposite of Law. A chaotic is selfish and respects no laws or rules. Chaotics cannot be trusted.

Neutral (or **Neutrality**) is concerned with personal survival. Neutrals will do whatever is in their best interest, with little regard for others.

Encumbrance (Optional)

The amount of treasure, armor, and equipment a character carries determines how fast the character moves. The weight of all items is measured in **coin weights (cn)**, since all coins weigh the same. The **Character Movement** table shows how fast an encumbered character moves, and the **Encumbrance** table lets characters calculate their load exactly (see page X2).

WEAPONS (Optional)

Two-Handed Weapons. Heavy two-handed weapons (flail, battle axe, pole arms, etc.) may strike once per round, but strike last in the round, regardless of initiative.

Crossbows. Crossbows may be fired once every two rounds, taking one round to load and one to fire.

Monsters

The monster section has been greatly expanded to include wilderness areas and deeper dungeon levels than were covered in the D&D Basic rules. Where the statistics given in the D&D Expert rules are different from those given in the D&D Basic rules, the monster statistics listed in D&D Expert should be used.

Treasure and Magic Items

Treasure Tables. The values listed in the D&D Expert Treasure Table are different from those listed in the blue book D&D Basic rules, and these tables should be used instead. There has been one change in the rate of exchange for coins: **10** copper pieces = 1 silver piece.

Magical Weapons. All magical hand-to-hand weapons add their bonuses to hit probability and damage.

Cursed Items. A character with a cursed item will not want to get rid of it, and will use it whenever possible. Such characters will fight to keep these items, if necessary. Only **Remove Curse**, or other similar spells, will free a character from a cursed item.

Placement of Treasure. The DM is not bound by the random tables and may assign appropriate treasure to monsters. Any treasure assigned should be equal to the difficulty of getting it. Note that intelligent monsters will use their magic items in combat with player characters, if possible.